

1. AudioRemove-AC3.ps1 is a pure-remux utility.

No video re-encoding; only remuxing streams.

Purpose:

Remove all **low-bitrate** legacy AC3 and E-AC3 audio tracks.

Result:

"Lean Master" movie contains only video and **high-fidelity audio**, which is retained (TrueHD/AAC 7.1/DTS-HD MA).

Use:

Prepares **mkv** movie for Conversion Engines (DDP51 / Keep71) to generate high-quality, high-bitrate (1024k) E-AC3 5.1 compatibility tracks.

2. Requirements AudioRemove-AC3.ps1

PowerShell 7.6 - Download PowerShell 7.6.1 (Windows x64 .msi)

FFmpeg 8.1 - <https://ffmpeg.org/download.html>

Quick Start (Windows 11)

1. Place `AudioRemove-AC3.ps1`, `ffmpeg.exe`, and `ffprobe.exe` in the same folder.
2. Run the script:

```
pwsh -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\AudioRemove-AC3.ps1 ".\YourMovie.mkv"
```

The -ExecutionPolicy Bypass only applies to this single run and doesn't change your system settings.

macOS / Linux

1. Place the script, `ffmpeg`, and `ffprobe` in the same folder.
2. Make the binaries executable (first time only):

```
chmod +x ffmpeg ffprobe
```

1. Run:

```
pwsh -File ./AudioRemove-AC3.ps1 "./YourMovie.mkv"
```

- The script will create a new file: **YourMovie_remux.mkv**
- If the file exists, it will auto-increment safely.

3. Supported Codecs

Audio Codecs — Kept

Codec Family	Examples
TrueHD	TrueHD 5.1, TrueHD 7.1, TrueHD+Atmos
DTS	DTS Core, DTS-HD MA, DTS-HD HRA
FLAC	All FLAC channel layouts
AAC	AAC LC, HE-AAC, AAC 5.1, AAC 7.1
Opus	Stereo + multichannel
PCM	pcms16le, pcms24le, pcm_f32le

Audio Codecs — Removed

Codec Family	Examples
AC3	ac3
E-AC3	eac3

Subtitle streams

You can switch subtitle handling at runtime by passing `-KeepAllSubs` on the command line:

```
pwsh -File .\AudioRemove-AC3.ps1 ".\Movie.mkv" -KeepAllSubs
```

To keep or drop subtitles (line 34)

```
[switch]$KeepAllSubs = $false <<< change to $True
```

\$false: (default) Drops non-English, keeps English + untagged only.

\$True : Keeps all subtitles including non-English.

- Subtitles kept or dropped are reported in the summary table.

Attachments — Kept

- Fonts, Cover art stored as an attachment stream, Any MKV attachment stream

Note: Cover art stored as an `ATTACHED_PIC` video stream is excluded by `-map 0:v?`.
To keep it, replace `0:v?` with `0:v?` in the script.

Data Streams — Dropped

1. Removed with warning, 2. Typically unused by players

4. Global FFmpeg Options

Ensure stable remuxing, correct metadata handling, and safe processing of large files.

```
-probesize 200M & -analyzeduration 200M
```

What: Deep probe of the input container.

Why: Ensures accurate detection of audio/subtitle streams, especially in large MKVs.

```
-max_muxing_queue_size
```

What: Prevents video flooding mux queue on long files.

Value: 14000 (1024-100000) recommended range

```
-fflags +discardcorrupt
```

What: Discards corrupt packets instead of aborting.

Why: Prevents remux failures on slightly damaged files.

`-avoid_negative_ts make_zero`

What: Normalizes timestamps to start at zero.

Why: Prevents sync drift caused by negative PTS values.

`-map_metadata 0` & `-map_chapters 0`

What: Copies global metadata and chapter markers.

Why: Preserves the original file's structure.

`-map 0:v?`

What: Maps all video streams except attached pictures (ATTACHED_PIC flag).

Why: Ensures video is preserved without modification.

`-c copy`

What: Stream-copy mode for all mapped streams.

Why: Guarantees zero quality loss and maximum speed.

Playback Assignment Rules

To ensure smooth playback, the rules are as follows:

- The first kept audio track will be set as **default**
- All other audio tracks will be set to **none**

5. Summary Report

After processing, the script generates a detailed table:

Column	Description
Idx	Original stream index. Dropped subtitle rows use a placeholder.
Codec	Codec used for audio, subtitle, or attachment
Action	Whether the stream was kept or removed
Rule	Reason for keeping or removing the stream

Color Coding for above table

- **Red** > Removed AC3/E-AC3
- **Green** > Kept audio
- **Cyan** > Kept subtitles
- **Magenta** > Kept attachments
- **Yellow** > Non-eng Subtitles dropped

6. Non-Critical FFmpeg Warnings (Safe to Ignore)

These warnings may appear during remuxing but **do not affect output quality**.

“discarding packet”

- Caused by minor corruption in the source
- Safe due to `+discardcorrupt`

“non-monotonous DTS”

- Happens when timestamps overlap
- Remux corrects this automatically

“Subtitle: unspecified size”

- Common for PGS subtitles
- Subtitles are copied untouched

“Estimating duration from bitrate, this may be inaccurate”

- FFmpeg recalculates duration during muxing
- Safe to Ignore